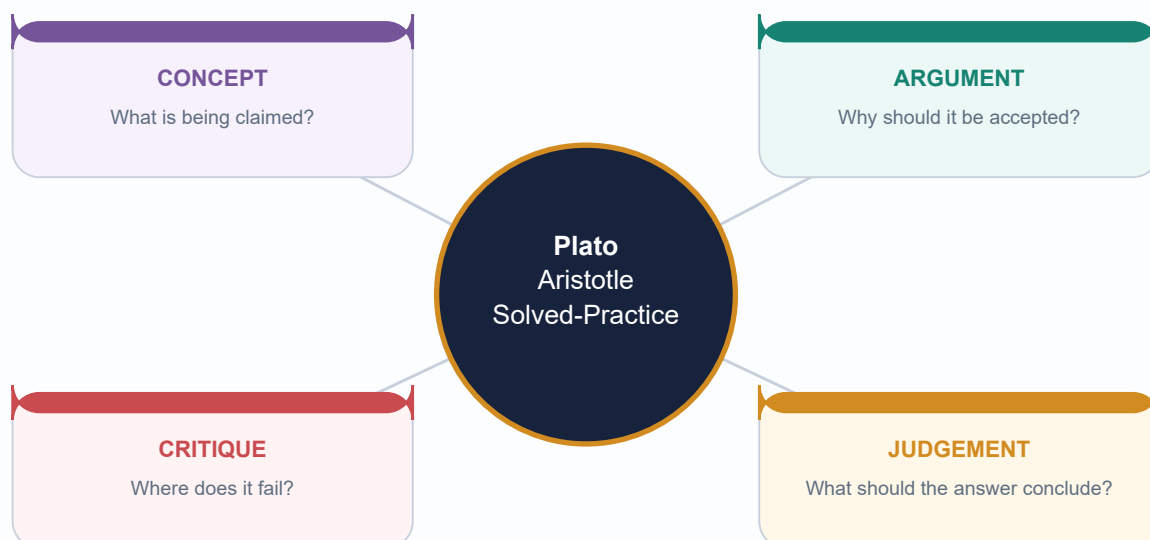


UPSC PHILOSOPHY WORKBOOK

Plato and Aristotle Solved-Practice Workbook

Subject: Philosophy | Paper: Philosophy Optional
Eight source-trap MCQs with strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation
Original 10-, 15- and 20-mark solved content frameworks



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Topic-Specific MCQ Loop 1

Philosophy
Optional
Philosophy

INTRO & ORIGIN

Each question is generated from an explicit source-chapter trap and explanation.

STATIC THEORY

- Q1. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct."?

- A. **Presupposition**: the self-predication assumption (the Form of Man is itself a man) + the non-identity assumption (the Form that explains the resemblance must be distinct from both the particular and the first Form).

- B. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- C. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- D. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- ANSWER: A - **Presupposition**: the self-predication assumption (the Form of Man is itself a man) + the non-identity assumption (the Form that explains the resemblance must be distinct from both the particular and the first Form).

- Q2. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct."?

- A. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- B. **Allegory of the Cave** (*Republic* VII): prisoners mistake shadows for reality; the philosopher ascends to sunlight (= the Good). The ascent is from *eikasia* → *pistis* → *dianoia* → *noēsis*. □ PYQ 2019 Q1(a) directly demands this.

- C. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- D. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- ANSWER: B - **Allegory of the Cave** (*Republic* VII): prisoners mistake shadows for reality; the philosopher ascends to sunlight (= the Good). The ascent is from *eikasia* → *pistis* → *dianoia* → *noēsis*. □ PYQ 2019 Q1(a) directly demands this.

- Q3. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct."?

- A. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- B. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- C. **Divided Line** (*Republic* VI 509d–511e): four segments = four cognitive states corresponding to four grades of reality.

- D. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- ANSWER: C - **Divided Line** (*Republic* VI 509d–511e): four segments = four cognitive states corresponding to four grades of reality.

- Q4. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct."?

- A. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- B. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- C. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- D. **Ideas as timeless and spaceless**: Forms occupy no location, undergo no temporal change, are not "in" space; hence they cannot be generated or destroyed. □ PYQ 2025 Q1(a): "Ideas are timeless and spaceless" — elucidate.

- ANSWER: D - **Ideas as timeless and spaceless**: Forms occupy no location, undergo no temporal change, are not "in" space; hence they cannot be generated or destroyed. □ PYQ 2025 Q1(a): "Ideas are timeless and spaceless" — elucidate.

MEMORY HOOK

Resolve the misconception before memorising the fact.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Plato and Aristotle -> Source-grounded practice

HIGH**Topic-Specific MCQ Loop 2**

Philosophy
Optional
Philosophy

INTRO & ORIGIN

Each question is generated from an explicit source-chapter trap and explanation.

STATIC THEORY

- Q5. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct."?

- A. **Primary substance** = the concrete individual thing — "this man," "this horse" (*tode ti*, "a this"). It is the ultimate subject of predication: everything else is either said *of* it or *in* it. ☐

- B. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- C. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- D. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- ANSWER: A - **Primary substance** = the concrete individual thing — "this man," "this horse" (*tode ti*, "a this"). It is the ultimate subject of predication: everything else is either said *of* it or *in* it. ☐

- Q6. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct."?

- A. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- B. **Secondary substance** = species and genus ("man," "animal") — said *of* the primary substance but less real than it.

- C. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- D. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- ANSWER: B - **Secondary substance** = species and genus ("man," "animal") — said *of* the primary substance but less real than it.

- Q7. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct."?

- A. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- B. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- C. **Reversal of Plato:** for Plato the universal is most real; for Aristotle the *individual* is most real. ☐

- D. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- ANSWER: C - **Reversal of Plato:** for Plato the universal is most real; for Aristotle the *individual* is most real. ☐

- Q8. Which statement correctly resolves this common misconception: "The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct."?

- A. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- B. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- C. The opposite or an unqualified version of the source proposition is correct.

- D. Substance = **form-matter compound** (*synolon*), but *form* (essence, the "what-it-is-to-be" = *to ti ēn einai*) has priority: it is what *makes* the thing what it is. ☐

- ANSWER: D - Substance = **form-matter compound** (*synolon*), but *form* (essence, the "what-it-is-to-be" = *to ti ēn einai*) has priority: it is what *makes* the thing what it is. ☐

MEMORY HOOK

Resolve the misconception before memorising the fact.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Plato and Aristotle -> Source-grounded practice

HIGH**Solved 10-Mark Practice**

Philosophy
Optional
Philosophy

INTRO & ORIGIN

Explain Plato and Aristotle with reference to its concepts, applications and limitations.

ANSWER ARCHITECTURE**1. Concept**

Define the exact scope and terminology.

V

2. Core analysis

Organise the source content into two or three dimensions.

V

3. Evidence

Use the chapter's India-centric examples or chronology.

V

4. Critical layer

Add traps, limitations, counter-view or implementation constraints.

V

5. Judgement

Conclude in direct response to the directive.

STATIC THEORY

- **Presupposition:** the self-predication assumption (the Form of Man is itself a man) + the non-identity assumption (the Form that explains the resemblance must be distinct from both the particular and the first Form).

- **Allegory of the Cave** (*Republic* VII): prisoners mistake shadows for reality; the philosopher ascends to sunlight (= the Good). The ascent is from *eikasia* → *pistis* → *dianoia* → *noēsis*. □ PYQ 2019 Q1(a) directly demands this.

- **Divided Line** (*Republic* VI 509d–511e): four segments = four cognitive states corresponding to four grades of reality.

- **Ideas as timeless and spaceless:** Forms occupy no location, undergo no temporal change, are not "in" space; hence they cannot be generated or destroyed. □ PYQ 2025 Q1(a): "Ideas are timeless and spaceless" — elucidate.

- **Primary substance** = the concrete individual thing — "this man," "this horse" (*tode ti*, "a this"). It is the ultimate subject of predication: everything else is either said *of* it or *in* it. □

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- **Reversal of Plato:** for Plato the universal is most real; for Aristotle the *individual* is most real. □

- Substance = **form-matter compound** (*synolon*), but *form* (essence, the "what-it-is-to-be" = *ti ēn einai*) has priority: it is what *makes* the thing what it is. □

- **Form is not the universal species** (that would re-introduce Platonism); it is the *individual organising principle* — □ this interpretation (individual forms vs universal forms in Aristotle) is contested among scholars, but for UPSC purposes: form = essence = the principle of identity and intelligibility internal to the substance. □□

- **Prime matter** (*prōtē hylē*) is the limiting concept of utterly indeterminate matter — it has no properties of its own; all properties belong to form. Pure form without matter = God (the Unmoved Mover); prime matter without form is a theoretical posit that never exists independently. □

- The final cause is **primary** — it is what the other causes *aim at*. The sculptor sculpts (efficient) bronze (material) into a certain shape (formal) **for the sake of** honouring the god (final). □

- **"Nature does nothing in vain"** — natural processes are inherently teleological: the seed grows into a tree *for the sake of* the tree's complete actuality.

- In natural substances the formal, efficient, and final causes often coincide: the form of "oak" is both the organising principle and the end toward which the acorn develops. □

- **Potentiality (dynamis):** the capacity of a thing to become something it is not yet. The wood is *potentially* a table; the acorn is *potentially* an oak. □

- **Actuality (energeia/entelecheia):** the *fulfilment* or *realisation* of that capacity. The table is the actuality of the wood-qua-potential-table; the oak is the actuality of the acorn. □

MAINS ANGLE

These are model content points; arrange them into paragraphs rather than reproducing a list.

STUDY LINK

Plato and Aristotle -> 10-mark answer

HIGH

Solved 15-Mark PracticePhilosophy
Optional
Philosophy**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Analyse Plato and Aristotle with reference to its concepts, applications and limitations.

ANSWER ARCHITECTURE**1. Concept**

Define the exact scope and terminology.

V

2. Core analysis

Organise the source content into two or three dimensions.

V

3. Evidence

Use the chapter's India-centric examples or chronology.

V

4. Critical layer

Add traps, limitations, counter-view or implementation constraints.

V

5. Judgement

Conclude in direct response to the directive.

STATIC THEORY

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- **Secondary substance** = species and genus ("man," "animal") — said *of* the primary substance but less real than it.

- **Reversal of Plato:** for Plato the universal is most real; for Aristotle the *individual* is most real. □

- Substance = **form-matter compound** (*synolon*), but *form* (essence, the "what-it-is-to-be" = *ti ēn einai*) has priority: it is what *makes* the thing what it is. □

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- **Potentiality (dynamis):** the capacity of a thing to become something it is not yet. The wood is *potentially* a table; the acorn is *potentially* an oak. □

- **Actuality (energeia/entelecheia):** the *fulfilment* or *realisation* of that capacity. The table is the actuality of the wood-qua-potential-table; the oak is the actuality of the acorn. □

MAINS ANGLE

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STUDY LINK

Plato and Aristotle -> 15-mark answer

HIGH

Solved 20-Mark PracticePhilosophy
Optional
Philosophy**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Critically examine Plato and Aristotle with reference to its concepts, applications and limitations.

ANSWER ARCHITECTURE**1. Concept**

Define the exact scope and terminology.

V

2. Core analysis

Organise the source content into two or three dimensions.

V

3. Evidence

Use the chapter's India-centric examples or chronology.

V

4. Critical layer

Add traps, limitations, counter-view or implementation constraints.

V

5. Judgement

Conclude in direct response to the directive.

STATIC THEORY

- **Presupposition:** the self-predication assumption (the Form of Man is itself a man) + the non-identity assumption (the Form that explains the resemblance must be distinct from both the particular and the first Form).

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MAINS ANGLE

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STUDY LINK

Plato and Aristotle -> 20-mark answer

HIGH

Workbook Rapid Revision

Philosophy
Optional
Philosophy

INTRO & ORIGIN

Final revision is placed after teaching and solved practice.

TOPIC RECALL MAP

Plato and Aristotle

V

Definition <i>Presupposition</i> : the self-predication assumption (the Form of Man is itself a man) + the non-identity assumption (the Form that explains the resemblance must be distinct from both the particular and the first Form).	Mechanism Allegory of the Cave (<i>Republic</i> VII): prisoners mistake shadows for reality; the philosopher ascends to sunlight (= the Good). The ascent is from <i>eikasia</i> → <i>pistis</i> → <i>dianoia</i> → <i>noēsis</i> . □ PYQ 2019 Q1(a) directly demands this.
Application Divided Line (<i>Republic</i> VI 509d–511e): four segments = four cognitive states corresponding to four grades of reality.	Evaluation Ideas as timeless and spaceless : Forms occupy no location, undergo no temporal change, are not "in" space; hence they cannot be generated or destroyed. □ PYQ 2025 Q1(a): "Ideas are timeless and spaceless" — elucidate.

STATIC THEORY

- *Presupposition*: the self-predication assumption (the Form of Man is itself a man) + the non-identity assumption (the Form that explains the resemblance must be distinct from both the particular and the first Form).

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MEMORY HOOK

Meaning -> mechanism -> evidence -> limitation -> judgement

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. In natural substances the formal, efficient, and final causes often coincide: the form of "oak" is both the organising principle and the end toward which the acorn develops. □
2. **Potentiality (dynamis)**: the capacity of a thing to become something it is not yet. The wood is *potentially* a table; the acorn is *potentially* an oak. □
3. **Actuality (energeia/entelecheia)**: the *fulfilment* or *realisation* of that capacity. The table is the actuality of the wood-qua-potential-table; the oak is the actuality of the acorn. □
4. **Change/motion** = "the actualisation of the potential *as* potential" (*Physics* III.1, 201a10). □
5. "Potentiality is indefinable" (PYQ 2021): Aristotle holds that *dynamis* cannot be defined independently of *energeia* — we understand what "potentially X" means only if we already understand what X *actually* is. Actuality is therefore *conceptually* prior to potentiality, even if temporally the potential acorn precedes the actual oak. □
6. **Pure actuality (actus purus)**: no unfulfilled potentiality whatsoever. If God had potentiality, He would be subject to change and dependency — inconsistent with divinity. □

MAINS ANGLE

Use Plato and Aristotle as an argument, not as an unstructured list of facts.

STUDY LINK

Philosophy -> Plato and Aristotle

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI